

Prevention of check

By C.G.S.Narayanan

Whether top-class three-movers are more difficult to construct than quality two-movers is a moot point but they certainly consume more working hours. According to Anderson in composing this joint three-mover below, its composers spent some three hundred hours of composing time between them. It is an exceptional masterpiece which requires elaborate study. Interferences and obstructions on the three potential 'bent lines' of black check allow the white knights and WPg5 to move off these lines.

V.L.Eaton & G.F.Anderson
I prize, British Chess Magazine 1953



Mate in three moves

Key move: **1.Bb1! zugzwang**

1...Bxa5 2.Nxd4 3.Ne6

(2...Rd6 3.Rf5)

1...Nxa5 2.Nd6 3.Re4

(2.Re4 3.Rf5)

1...Nc5 2.Nc3 3.NxR

(2. d4xNc3 3.dxe3)

1...Bc5 2.Nc7 3.Nxd5, Nd6

1...Nd8 2.g5xh6 Rf5, Re4

1...Nd6 2.Nf8 3.Ne6, Ng6

These are the six main variations which are forced for a wide variety of tactics. Noteworthy is partial paralysis of black in Nc5 and Bc5.

Edgar Holladay commenting on this in 'American Chess Bulletin' called it

an object lesson to those composers who rush feverishly from one problem to the next in an effort to increase the quantity of their output and as a result produce very little of permanent value.

The second one below shows masked prevention of check.

Jan Hartong

Tidskrift KNSB 1940(v)



Mate in three moves

Checks to the white king would arise from the removal of masking men. The logic of the thematic variations would be the same if black units alone masked the checking line and the WN and WP started from somewhere else.

Key 1.Qe7! threat 2.Qg7

1...Bg3 2.Nf3+ gxf3 3.c3

1...Nd3 2.c3+ Nxc3+ 3.Nf3

Now for a problem for solving

L.J.Richenberg, Observer 1960



Mate in three moves

Solution to problem for solving in the article 'Evolution of a theme'

Key 1.Qb1 ! threat: 2.Qxg6 3.Qg4

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